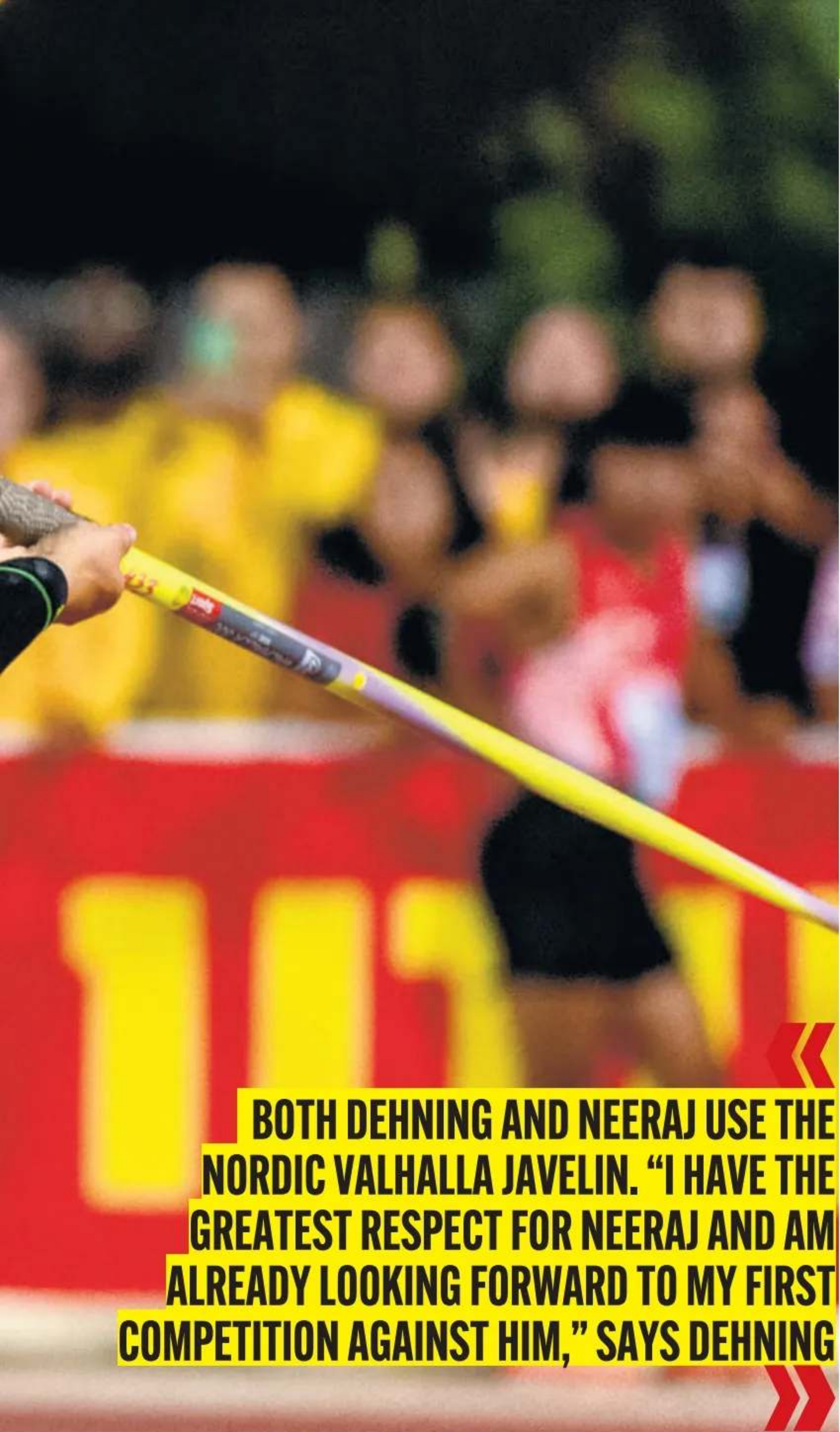




BOTH DEHNING AND NEERAJ USE THE NORDIC VALHALLA JAVELIN. "I HAVE THE GREATEST RESPECT FOR NEERAJ AND AM ALREADY LOOKING FORWARD TO MY FIRST COMPETITION AGAINST HIM," SAYS DEHNING

strongest attribute would definitely be my power," says Dehning.

Power game

But Dehning doesn't just bank on raw power. "I know I'm one of the stronger guys, but strength isn't everything. Speed is one of the most important basics in javelin throw.

"I'm very fast in short sprints of up to 30 metres but not very good beyond that; but that's enough for javelin throw. At the same time, I think my technique is very strong. I think that's also because I have the ability to stay calm. When I'm under pressure, I'm able to just focus on my technique," he says.

Simple does it: Aware of how Johannes Vetter threw over 90m a record seven times in 2021 before faltering where it mattered most, in Tokyo, Dehning just wants to keep things simple this season. GETTYIMAGES

Having got his first 90m throw under his belt, Dehning doesn't plan to stop anytime soon.

"In the next few years, my goals are to become an Olympic champion and to celebrate more throws over 90m," he says.

Also on the horizon is the 28-year-old world record of 98.48m set by Jan Zelezny. [The javelin record books were reset post the introduction of new rules and equipment specs in 1986. As a result, Uwe's achievement was archived and has been considered an 'eternal record' ever since].

"I think anything is possible. The world record in the men's category is definitely a realistic goal for the next few years. If my development continues as it has in recent years, we can look forward to more successful competitions," he says.

For this year though he's not putting too much pressure on himself.

Aware of how Vetter threw over 90m a record seven times in 2021 before faltering where it mattered most, in Tokyo, Dehning just wants to keep things simple this season.

"My most important goal for 2024 is to stay healthy. The rest will take care of itself," he says, adding that he is simply looking forward to rubbing shoulders with the sport's elite in Paris.

One athlete he particularly wants to test himself against is the reigning World and Olympic champion Neeraj.

"I haven't met him yet, but it would definitely be very cool if I could," says Dehning, who uses the Nordic Valhalla javelin just like the Indian.

"I have the greatest respect for Neeraj and am already looking forward to my first competition against him. I will give my best at the Olympics, and am looking forward to an exciting javelin final!" he says.